



**Village of Saranac Lake**

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Dear Review Committee,

As Mayor of the Village of Saranac Lake, I am writing to express strong support for our application to the Smart Growth Grant program to secure funding for contractual services related to upgrades at the Lake Colby Beach.

Lake Colby Beach is a vital community resource where residents and visitors come together to enjoy recreation and the natural beauty of the Adirondacks. However, the existing facilities do not meet current accessibility standards, limiting the ability of many individuals to use the space safely and comfortably.

This grant funding will allow the Village to engage the professional services necessary to design, engineer, and implement ADA-compliant upgrades, including accessible bathrooms, lifeguard facilities, and safe pathways. The expertise of contracted professionals is essential to ensure the project meets regulatory requirements and provides long-term, sustainable improvements.

These upgrades will not only enhance accessibility and equity but also support the Smart Growth principles of sustainable community development, improved quality of life, and economic vitality through inclusive recreation.

On behalf of the Village of Saranac Lake, I respectfully urge your strong consideration of this application. With your support, we can ensure that Lake Colby Beach is a safe, welcoming, and inclusive destination for generations to come.

Sincerely,

Jimmy Williams

Mayor, Village of Saranac Lake